



Lecture

Newsletters /Fliers

Newsletter

- Newsletters can be one page or more. As with brochures, newsletters can help students practice technical writing skills:
- clarity
- conciseness
- accessible document design
- audience recognition
- accuracy.

Criteria for Designing Newsletter

- The Flag

It Includes the following:

- title of your newsletter
- the date of its publication

perhaps the publication volume and issue number .The Flag will be placed at the top of your newsletter in a bold, large font.

Newsletter

- 2. Columns
- Divide your newsletter into two to three columns. Strive for variety; the top half of the page could have two columns while the bottom half would use three, for example.

Newsletter

- 3. Headlines and Subheadings
- Help your readers navigate the text by providing the following:
 - A headline for the major article on page one
 - first-level headings for all other articles
 - second-level

Newsletter

- In your headings and subheadings, use present tense, avoid excessive punctuation, omit titles (such as Dr., Mr., Mrs., Ms.), avoid abbreviations and acronyms, use strong verbs, and use short words and phrases

Newsletter

- Pop-Up Quotes

Gain your reader's interest through pop-up quotes. These “talk bubbles” or “pull-out quotes” are usually:

- printed in larger font than the articles.
- centred on a page or within a column.
- printed inside a border.
- printed in a different colour

Newsletter

- 5. Sidebars
 - Add variety to your page layout through sidebars. These are often shaded or gradient-colored textboxes which present late-breaking, additional, and/or contrasting short news items.
- 6. Table of Contents
 - It Includes a table of contents to help your readers find information within the newsletter.

7. Initial caps

- **Any** newsletters begin each article with an initial cap for visual appeal. Use these larger, capital letters to preface the first word of the first sentence of an article—as shown in this paragraph.

Newsletter

- Newsletter Style
- As in all effective technical writing:
- limit your word length (one-two syllables)
- limit sentence length (10-15 words)
- limit paragraph length.
- (The length of paragraphs is especially important when writing a newsletter, since columns make your writing more cramped. You want to limit your paragraphs to four to six lines.

Newsletter

- 9.Highlighting
- Add interest to your newsletter by including typical highlighting techniques, such as:
 - tables and figures
 - font changes
 - bullets
 - Numbering
 - boldface and italics.



Newsletter

10. Accuracy

Proofread to avoid grammatical errors.

Fliers

- Fliers get the word out! Fliers, as small as a postcard or as large as one, 8½ x 11 page, are external correspondence sent to prospective or existing customers.
- Fliers, usually limited to one, very specific topic, highlight a way in which you or your company can meet a customer's unique needs. How could your students use fliers? Fliers are effective for inviting like parents to dramatic plays. Agricultural Education students could create fliers about hydroponic plants; Family and Consumer Science students could create fliers about food products, nutritional ideas, or clothing construction; Industrial Technology students could create fliers about robotics, aviation, or computer-aided drawing.

Fliers

- Fliers come with easy-to-use Microsoft Wizards As always, the students would open Microsoft Word or Microsoft Publisher. In Word, the students would click on File, scroll to New, click on the Direct Mail Manager tab, and then click on Flyer Wizard. (It seems that flier can be spelled several different ways!)
- (If using Microsoft Publisher, choose the Flyers link and then one of several optional templates provided.)

Criteria for fliers

- 1. Limit the Length of your Flier to one page (8½ x 11).
- 2. Focus on one Specific Idea. This could be a feature, a benefit, a component, a use, a person, a place, an object, an activity, etc. Consider a technical description/specification. Then, your Flier could focus on dimension, colors, material, etc. This, of course, would only apply if you were writing about a product. For a service, a person, or a place, your Flier would focus on some other user benefit.
- 3. Include a Title at the top of your Flier. A word, a phrase, a question—but give it impact to attract your reader's interest!
- 4. Limit your Text. As with all good technical writing, text should be short. Strive for no more than 100 words, or fewer. Remember, a graphic should be the key to your Flier (more on this in point number 6 below).

Fliers

- Increase your Font size. You want your reader to see the key points at a glance. Increased font size, with limited text, will help accomplish this goal. Think 20 point and up for titles, 16 point and up for subtitles, and 12 point and up for text.
- 6. Use Graphics. This is important. Let a picture emphasize your key point and draw the reader's attention. This could either be a technical specification, as shown in the sample, or a host of other possibilities.
- 7. Use Color. Attract your reader's attention, but be careful. Don't overuse color. A little bit goes a long way.
- 8. Use Highlighting techniques. As with color, a little bit goes a long way. Be careful. Limit yourself to no more than three or so highlighting techniques.
- 9. Find the "Phrase." Be clever. Come up with 3-5 words that draw your reader in and/or that highlight your topic's worth or reader benefit.